

GeoNews — Week 32/2026

A weekly digest on Quaternary palaeoclimate research, East African rift dynamics, palaeohydrology and time-series analysis · 3 August 2026

What is GeoNews? An **automatically generated weekly digest**. A research workflow screens the publications of the past one to two weeks along with funding, policy and community sources, scores the hits against a fixed set of criteria, and assembles this issue from the result.

The thematic profile is **aligned with the research interests of Markus L. Fischer** (Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam): Quaternary palaeoclimate and palaeoenvironmental reconstruction, the East African Rift, the African Humid Period and human-environment coupling, lake-level and water-balance modelling, palaeofloods and fluvial geomorphology, ICDP drill cores, and linear and nonlinear time-series analysis. Anyone working in these fields will probably find something useful here — it is explicitly not a complete survey of Quaternary science.

Selection, scoring and summaries are produced by machine and reviewed before publication. Details may contain errors; where in doubt, the linked original source governs.

Each paper receives a score from 0 to 100 across five criteria: thematic fit (40), methodological fit (25), impact/venue (15), applicability (10) and recency (10). Categories: ● 75 and above, must-read · ● 50–74, relevant · ● 30–49, on the radar. The score measures proximity to this newsletter's profile and sets reading priority; it is not a quality judgement on the individual paper.

In brief

Six relevant papers, four on the radar, plus ten title-level records from the Elsevier core journals — and, for the first time in three issues, a ● must-read at the top. Crossref access from the compute environment was blocked as in previous weeks (proxy 403); the topic- and ISSN-based queries therefore ran entirely through the browser-based fetch interface and covered the same core journals as a normal run. Crossref abstracts were available for the non-Elsevier titles (MDPI, AGU/Wiley, Cambridge, Copernicus); the Elsevier titles again sit without abstract and without a score in a separate block.

At the top is the single paper of the week that hits the core of the profile directly: a study in *Water* on the rising lake level of **Lake Baringo in the Kenyan Rift** — central both regionally and thematically (East African Rift, lake-level/water-balance dynamics), albeit as a present-day flood-risk assessment rather than a palaeo reconstruction (hence the venue and method deductions in the score). Methodologically the most interesting are two papers in *JGR*: a palaeoclimate **data assimilation of the 4.2 ka event** across monsoon Asia, which frames the event as a spatially heterogeneous hydroclimate within Holocene variability and challenges the reading of it as a global megadrought; and a process study of an **extreme flood in Death Valley** showing how short-lived fluvial extreme signals are preserved in an arid dune field — a direct analogue for the preservation question in palaeoflood research. Added to these are a fluvial-tectonic incision study from the eastern Tibetan Plateau, two geoarchaeological-anthropological papers (Neanderthal

bone tools in Romania; new hominin postcrania from Kromdraai), and a methodological paper on non-Gaussian data assimilation in latent space.

On funding the focus is unchanged: the Horizon palaeoclimate call **HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08** (opening 17 November 2026, deadline 4 March 2027), the **ERC Starting Grant 2027** (15 October 2026) and the **PAGES applications** (11 September 2026). Near-term and urgent: the **AGU abstract deadline on 5 August 2026** — in two days. On research policy the **WissZeitVG reform adopted by cabinet on 29 July 2026** remains the defining item; the parliamentary debate in the Bundestag is expected after the summer recess, in September.

Part A — Papers of the week

Papers were captured with a `created` or online date from 20 July 2026 onwards. DOIs already listed in the issues of 20 July, 27 July and 2 August are excluded. Every scored entry in the ●, ● and ● categories rests on an abstract that was inspected; the closing ○ block lists papers from the Elsevier core journals for which no abstract was accessible — without a score and without any claim about their content.

● Must-read (75 and above)

1. Rising Lake Levels as a Distinct Flood Hazard: An Integrated Risk Assessment

Framework for Semi-Arid Inland Lake Basins · *Water*, 2026 · **Score 79** An integrated flood-risk assessment for rising inland lake levels, using **Lake Baringo in the Kenyan Rift** — which has experienced an exceptional lake-level rise of nearly 10 m since 2010 — as a case study. The study combines scenario-based flood hazard modelling, spatial exposure assessment and household vulnerability analysis across three lake-level scenarios, from the observed maximum to a worst case at the basin's sill point. Finding: under the worst case, the lake area could expand by about 64 percent, potentially exposing nearly 18,000 people and 156 km of road infrastructure; a Flood Vulnerability Index (0.58–0.73) indicates consistently high socioeconomic vulnerability (42–53 percent of overall risk), with the highest risk along the flat southern shoreline where topography amplifies lateral inundation. Relevant because region and theme coincide here as in no other paper this week: the East African Rift and lake-level/water-balance dynamics are central profile anchors. The character is worth stating plainly — a present-day hazard study, not a palaeo reconstruction; its value for the profile lies in the regional proximity and in the question of how to quantify lake-level scenarios and inundation extent in the Rift. Precisely that venue and method character holds the score down despite full thematic, applicability and recency points. *Theme 40* · *Method 13* · *Venue 6* · *Applicability 10* · *Recency 10* (created 3 Aug 2026) · DOI: [10.3390/w18151887](https://doi.org/10.3390/w18151887)

● Relevant (50–74)

2. Precipitation Reconstruction in the Asian Monsoon Region During the 4.2 ka Event With Paleoclimate Data Assimilation

· *Journal of Geophysical Research: Atmospheres*, 2026 · **Score 68** A palaeoclimate data assimilation of the 4.2 ka event (4.3–3.9 ka BP) across monsoon Asia: high-resolution speleothem $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ series and a transient simulation of an isotope-enabled Earth-system model are combined via an offline ensemble Kalman filter into a spatiotemporal reconstruction of $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ and precipitation (10-year resolution, $2.5^\circ \times 1.9^\circ$). Finding: at the centennial scale a drought pattern in northern China and South Asia coincides with wet conditions in southern China; at the multi-decadal scale, frequent wet-dry excursions occur — both largely

within the range of natural Holocene variability. The work thereby challenges the common reading of the 4.2 ka event as a global megadrought and portrays it, even within monsoon Asia, as a spatially heterogeneous hydroclimate. Methodologically the most interesting paper of the week: palaeoclimate data assimilation with a Kalman filter is exactly the toolbox that also supports reconstruction of abrupt transitions (such as the AHP termination) and the question of how event and background variability relate. *Theme 25 · Method 20 · Venue 9 · Applicability 8 · Recency 6* (created 20 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2025JD045745](https://doi.org/10.1029/2025JD045745)

3. Fluvial-Aeolian Interactions and Landscape Recovery After Extreme Events: A Death Valley Dune Field After Hurricane Hilary · *Journal of Geophysical Research: Earth Surface*, 2026 · **Score 65**

A process study of the interaction between fluvial and aeolian sediment transport after the record rainfall of Hurricane Hilary (August 2023) in the Mesquite Flat Dune Field, Death Valley. Repeat satellite imagery, field observations and terrestrial LiDAR quantify flood depths, sediment volumes and the pace of landscape recovery. Finding: floodwaters penetrated more than one kilometre into the dune-field interior, forming interdune ponds up to 3.9 m deep; on receding, the turbid water left millimetre-to-centimetre mud drapes that armoured the surface against aeolian erosion. Where dunes were fluvially removed, new dunes re-formed in less than two years; the fluvial mud layers, by contrast, were rapidly abraded by wind and are unlikely to enter the rock record except where quickly buried. Relevant as a process and preservation analogue for palaeoflood research: the study shows concretely under what conditions a fluvial extreme signal is archived at all in an arid system — the same question that governs the interpretability of fluvial extreme-event archives. *Theme 25 · Method 15 · Venue 9 · Applicability 6 · Recency 10* (created 31 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2025JF008995](https://doi.org/10.1029/2025JF008995)

4. Linking Fluvial Incision and Landslide Activity in a Tectonically Active Landscape · *Journal of Geophysical Research: Earth Surface*, 2026 · **Score 63**

Quantification of the coupling between fluvial incision and landslide activity in the Xiaojin Basin on the eastern margin of the Tibetan Plateau, where the main rivers run within a Triassic folded belt so that lithological, topographic and meteorological confounders remain largely constant. The normalised channel steepness index (k_{sn}) serves as a morphometric proxy for relative incision, linked to a landslide analysis. Relevant as a clean example of quantitative fluvial geomorphology with a clearly isolated forcing — methodologically transferable to the separation of forcing and response in fluvial and hillslope systems, as is also relevant for palaeoflood and sediment-budget questions. *Theme 25 · Method 13 · Venue 9 · Applicability 6 · Recency 10* (created 31 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2025JF008905](https://doi.org/10.1029/2025JF008905)

5. Insights into Neanderthal technological practices: Evidence of anthropogenic modifications on animal bones at the Abri 122/1200 Middle Paleolithic site (Eastern Carpathians, Romania) · *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 58**

Evidence of anthropogenic modification of animal bones (bone tools) at the Middle Palaeolithic site of Abri 122/1200 in the Eastern Carpathians, filling a gap in the geographic distribution of Neanderthal bone use between the Altai and the Atlantic. Luminescence dating provides the chronological framework for the Middle Palaeolithic occupation. Relevant as a Quaternary geoarchaeological paper with explicit geochronology: luminescence-based age control and the coupling of site stratigraphy to human–environment questions touch the same method and chronology issues that are also central in working East African site contexts. *Theme 25 · Method 13 · Venue 8 · Applicability 6 · Recency 6* (created 21 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70098](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70098)

6. New hominin postcranial fossils from Kromdraai, South Africa (2014–2025) · *The Anatomical Record*, 2026 · **Score 54**

A description of 21 postcranial hominin elements (four partial humeri, five manual phalanges, two femora, two patellae, eight pedal elements) from the

type locality of *Paranthropus robustus*. Twenty of the finds come from Unit P (over 2.0 million years old, with craniodental material of *Paranthropus* and *Homo*); notably, while more than half of that unit's craniodental remains are juvenile, all of the postcrania are adult. Relevant as a building block of hominin evolution in southern Africa and thus at the edge of the profile's human–environment coupling — thematically related, but methodologically (comparative anatomy) away from the core toolkit, which dampens the score. *Theme 25 · Method 6 · Venue 7 · Applicability 6 · Recency 10* (created 3 Aug 2026) · DOI: [10.1002/ar.70300](https://doi.org/10.1002/ar.70300)

7. Non-Gaussian Assimilation of Atmospheric and Oceanic Data in Latent Space · *Journal of Advances in Modeling Earth Systems*, 2026 · **Score 52** A methodological paper on assimilating atmospheric and oceanic observations in a learned latent space, seeking to bypass the assumptions of classical schemes that are problematic under strongly non-Gaussian distributions. Relevant less thematically than methodologically: non-Gaussian assimilation and state estimation in latent space are directly relevant to palaeoclimate data assimilation and to nonlinear time-series/state reconstruction — the same method family that carries paper 2 in this issue. The comparatively low thematic proximity (general assimilation methodology) limits the score despite high method, venue and recency values. *Theme 12 · Method 16 · Venue 9 · Applicability 5 · Recency 10* (created 28 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2026MS005767](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026MS005767)

● On the radar

- **Valley longitudinal profiles record the fluvial landscape evolution and geological structure of the Gamburtsev Subglacial Mountains, East Antarctica** · *Earth Surface Dynamics* · **48** ● · Valley longitudinal profiles of the Gamburtsev range, buried beneath ~2 km of ice, are extracted from radar survey data to reconstruct its fluvial landscape evolution and geological structure. Noted as a drainage-network / landscape-evolution methods paper at the edge of the profile. DOI: [10.5194/esurf-14-575-2026](https://doi.org/10.5194/esurf-14-575-2026)
- **Reconstructing Spatial Denudation Patterns in a Reverse-Engineered Fluvial Catchment** · *EarthArXiv (preprint)* · **47** ● · △ *Preprint* · A sediment-flux-based framework to estimate spatial denudation rates in a generic, reverse-engineered fluvial catchment; the drainage network controls the pattern while climate and regolith properties control the magnitude. Noted as a sediment-budget / source-to-sink methods paper. DOI: [10.31223/x5br37](https://doi.org/10.31223/x5br37)
- **Anastomosing fluvial sedimentation in a foreland basin: paleoclimatic and tectonic controls on the Middle Eocene Gercus Formation, Kurdistan Region, NE Iraq** · *Acta Geologica Polonica* · **42** ● · A sedimentological–mineralogical analysis of an anastomosing fluvial system with a palaeoclimatic signal (palygorskite–dolomite indicating a seasonal water balance); at the edge of the Quaternary profile owing to its deep-time (Eocene) setting. DOI: [10.24425/agp.2026.158200](https://doi.org/10.24425/agp.2026.158200)
- **Topographic modulation of modern vegetation–climate coupling across China: Implications for global-change ecology and paleoclimate reconstruction** · *SSRN (preprint)* · **42** ● · △ *Preprint* · Mapping of 22 vegetation communities across China with a Transformer-based graph CNN as a modern-analogue basis for palaeoclimate reconstruction; noted as an ML/methods paper at the interface of vegetation–climate coupling and reconstruction. DOI: [10.2139/ssrn.7163483](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7163483)

◦ Screened without an abstract — Elsevier core journals

These ten papers come from the Elsevier journals in the profile and fall inside the window. Crossref records them with title, journal, DOI and `created` date, but deposits no abstracts for Elsevier; ScienceDirect is not retrievable from this compute environment, and the articles are days old and not yet in search indices. They are therefore listed **without a score and without content annotation** — the note states only the thematic connection that follows from the title. What the papers actually say is decided by the full text.

Hominins, human–environment and geoarchaeology

- **Neanderthals in the desert? Population history best explains Middle Palaeolithic technological variability** · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, created 2 Aug 2026 · Thematic link per title: a population-history explanation of Middle Palaeolithic technological variability. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110196](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110196)
- **The Skateholm networks and hunting grounds: Late Mesolithic cultural and territorial legacy** · *Quaternary Science Advances*, created 2 Aug 2026 · Thematic link per title: Late Mesolithic settlement and territorial structure in a lakeshore/coastal context. DOI: [10.1016/j.qsa.2026.100339](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.qsa.2026.100339)
- **Dogs, maize, and agricultural intensification in the Tehuacan Valley of south-central Mexico** · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, created 29 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: stable-isotope reconstruction of agricultural intensification and human–animal relations. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110189](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110189)

Isotope hydroclimate and monsoon

- **Westerly-associated inverse altitude effects in near-surface water vapor isotopes across Central Asia** · *Global and Planetary Change*, created 31 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: altitude and westerly controls on water-vapour isotopes as a basis for isotope palaeohydrology. DOI: [10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105642](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105642)
- **Quantifying the controls of spatiotemporal variations in precipitation isotopes across Southeast Asia** · *Earth and Planetary Science Letters*, created 29 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: controls on the precipitation-isotope signature in the monsoon domain — a calibration basis for proxy interpretation. DOI: [10.1016/j.epsl.2026.120248](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.epsl.2026.120248)

Multiproxy palaeoclimate and biomarkers

- **Hydrocarbons and genomic biomarker-based paleoclimate and ecological variability** · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, created 30 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: biomarker- and genome-based reconstruction of palaeoclimatic and ecological variability. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110192](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110192)
- **Multiproxy sediment record in Collins Harbour (South Shetland Islands) and controls on marine productivity** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, created 30 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: multiproxy reconstruction of marine productivity in a polar sediment archive. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114110](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114110)
- **Carbon sink dynamics and resilience thresholds of a volcanic island land-sea system in the Beibu Gulf** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, created 30 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: resilience thresholds and carbon dynamics of a coupled land-sea system. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114105](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114105)

- **Late Holocene slope dynamics and associated landforms on the slopes of Mount Flautafell, NE Iceland** · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, created 30 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: late-Holocene slope dynamics and landforms — a sediment and process archive. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110191](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110191)
 - **Provenance and bottom currents drive Holocene sand accumulation in the Bengal Fan** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, created 29 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: Holocene source-to-sink dynamics and bottom-current control on sand accumulation. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114106](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114106)
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Part B — Funding & calls

Horizon Europe — "Palaeoclimate science for a better understanding of Earth system dynamics" (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08). Opening **17 November 2026**, deadline **4 March 2027**, Research and Innovation Action, budget around **€14 million for about two projects**, i.e. roughly €7 million per consortium. Stated aim: robust information on palaeoclimate states and events beyond the variability of the last few centuries, as a basis for advancing Earth-system models. With two funded projects Europe-wide the competition is stiff, so consortium conversations should start early. Sources: [Topic page](#) · [CL5 Work Programme 2026–2027 \(PDF\)](#).

ERC Starting Grant 2027 — deadline 15 October 2026. Step-1 results in April 2027, interviews and step-2 results in August 2027. Eligibility: PhD defence at most ten years before 1 January 2027, extendable for parental and care leave. New from the 2027 calls: at most one Starting and one Consolidator Grant per career, plus tightened application rules. The **ERC Consolidator 2027** is expected in January 2027. Sources: [ERC — Applying in the 2027 competitions](#) · [ERC — Changes to the 2026 and 2027 Work Programmes](#).

PAGES — working-group and workshop support, deadline 11 September 2026. The next round of applications for workshops, meetings, new working groups and extensions of existing groups. Ahead of the Horizon palaeoclimate call, a low-cost instrument for visibly forming a consortium. In addition: **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027**, deadline **29 September 2026**. Sources: [PAGES — Workshop/meeting support](#) · [PAGES Newsletter July 2026](#).

ICDP — proposal cycle. The regular annual deadline for full, pre- and workshop proposals is **15 January**; the 2027 cycle is likely to follow the same pattern, though a formal announcement is not yet out. Workshop calls run year-round. Source: [ICDP — Proposals](#).

DFG — changed framework conditions. No new palaeoclimate-specific call. Important for planning: the **programme allowance rises from 22 to 25 percent from 2027**; the next **Priority Programme application round** is only in **late 2026**, with funding from **2028**. Additionally, and at the edge of subject funding: applications for the **DFG Communicator Award 2027** (science communication) are open **3 August to 30 September 2026**. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — 25 instead of 22 percent from 2027](#) · [DFG — press releases 2026](#).

Part C — Science policy (DE/EU)

WissZeitVG — reform adopted by cabinet on 29 July 2026; Bundestag to follow in the autumn. The federal cabinet adopted the draft law modernising fixed-term employment law in

science on 29 July 2026; the May ministerial draft was revised in parts after criticism from associations. At its core are, for the first time, binding **minimum contract durations: three years for first contracts of doctoral researchers, two years for postdocs**; the maximum fixed-term duration in the postdoc phase is standardised at **six years**. According to parliamentary sources, debate in the Bundestag is expected after the summer recess, i.e. in September. As interpretation, not established fact: minimum durations improve the predictability of early contracts, while the removal of earlier carry-over flexibility further narrows individual fixed-term planning in the postdoc phase — the further parliamentary path remains to be watched. Sources: [BMFTR — Cabinet adopts amendment to the WissZeitVG](#) · [Bundestag — Reform of the Wissenschaftszeitvertragsgesetz](#) · [Wiarda blog — WissZeitVG: BMFTR presents ministerial draft](#).

Federal budget 2027 — cabinet decision of 6 July 2026, Bundestag to follow in the autumn. The government draft has stood since 6 July 2026. The BMFTR core budget is around **€22 billion** — a nominal increase of only about **0.7 percent** on 2026. Real growth is almost entirely in the special fund for infrastructure and climate neutrality, whose R&D investments rise markedly in 2027 relative to 2026. The parliamentary reading (first reading) is due in the autumn. As interpretation: the regular budget stagnates in real terms given current wage and material-cost increases, keeping the operating position of the funding organisations under pressure. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — Only a slim increase for the BMFTR core budget](#) · [Table.Briefings — Budget 2027](#).

DFG cuts at the postdoc level. Owing to high wage increases and rising equipment and consumable costs that the promised annual funding increments do not cover, the DFG has postponed the funding start of establishment applications for Research Training Groups and **suspended the approval of postdoc positions**. For postdoc career paths in the geosciences this removes a financing route for now, increasing pressure on individual-grant and EU funds. Source: [Fakultätentag Informatik](#).

Part D — Community & dates

- **AGU Fall Meeting 2026 — 7-11 December 2026 in San Francisco**; abstract deadline **5 August 2026** (23:59 EDT) — in two days. Source: [AGU](#).
 - **PAGES working-group and workshop applications — 11 September 2026** · **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027 — 29 September 2026**.
 - **DEUQUA meeting 2026 — 28 September to 2 October 2026 in Freiburg im Breisgau**, with full-day excursions on 28 September and 2 October. Source: [DEUQUA](#).
 - **ERC Starting Grant 2027** — deadline **15 October 2026**.
 - **Horizon CL5 palaeoclimate call** — opening **17 November 2026**, deadline **4 March 2027**.
 - **EGU General Assembly 2027 — 4 to 9 April 2027 in Vienna**, hybrid. Abstract deadline not yet published; historically mid-January. Source: [EGU](#).
 - **ICDP** — next regular proposal deadline expected **15 January 2027**, following the pattern of previous years and not yet confirmed.
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Methods & sources

The paper screening uses the Crossref REST API with topic- and ISSN-based queries and the `from-created-date` filter (window from 20 July 2026). DOIs already listed in an earlier issue are not repeated. Funding opportunities, science policy and dates rest on the sources linked in Parts B to D.

On how this issue came about. Crossref access from the compute environment was blocked by a proxy 403, as in previous weeks. The queries therefore ran entirely through the browser-based fetch interface — topic- and ISSN-based across the core journals (QSR, EPSL, GPC, P³, Boreas, JQS, Quaternary Research, Quaternary Science Advances, Communications Earth & Environment, Nature Geoscience, The Holocene, GRL, JGR) and the Copernicus layer (Climate of the Past, Earth Surface Dynamics, Geochronology, Earth System Dynamics and EGU sphere preprints). Crossref abstracts were available for the non-Elsevier publishers (including MDPI, AGU/Wiley, Cambridge, Copernicus) and were inspected for every scored entry.

What remains open. Elsevier deposits no abstracts with Crossref. The usual workaround via the publisher page was unavailable: ScienceDirect responds from this environment with a bot check, and the papers are days old and thus not yet in search indices. Rather than infer results from titles, these ten papers sit in a separate, correspondingly marked block without a score and without any claim about content. For the scored entries the rule is unchanged: every substantive statement rests on an inspected abstract; preprints are marked as such.

Note on the week number. This run falls on Monday, 3 August 2026 — the first day of ISO calendar week 32. The previous issue (Sunday, 2 August) still carried week number 31; the count therefore jumps by one relative to the last issue.

GeoNews is an automatically generated digest, published by Dr. Markus L. Fischer, Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam. The thematic profile follows his research interests; the selection is made by a rule-based workflow, not an editorial team. The digest is an independent literature overview with no connection to the publishers or funding bodies named, and constitutes neither a recommendation nor advice. Corrections and pointers are welcome.